

Vivo X300 Pro

The Optical Overlord

By the end of 2025, humanity is predicted to have made over 2 trillion images worldwide. Over 94% of these images come from smartphones and in India, where more than 97% populace use mobile phones, it becomes imperative for smartphone brands to offer unparalleled camera experiences. This is the environment into which the Vivo X300 Pro arrives, a phone that evolves the idea of what a modern mobile camera system should realistically feel like.

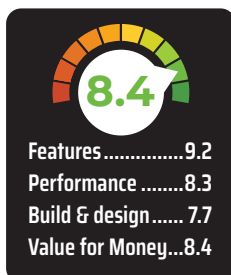
The X300 Pro carries a new ZEISS-certified 200-megapixel APO telephoto camera (based on Samsung ISOCELL HPB sensor), an upgraded gimbal-grade main LYT-828 sensor, an imaging pipeline that leans heavily on dedicated VS1 silicon for pre- and post-processing and the introduction of the 2.35x telephoto extender kit, an actual lens that is a step up in mobile imaging.

But this isn't just about the cameras alone. This is still a flagship with MediaTek's Dimensity 9500 SoC, competing in a market where every competitor is pushing computational photography to new extremes. So, the question is whether all of this translates into a genuinely better daily experience and can a device this photography-centric still hold its ground as an all-round flagship for people who don't shoot professionally but want dependable results? Those questions are where this review begins.

DESIGN & BUILD

I've been using the X300 Pro in Dune Gold, but it also comes in Elite Black which looks more formal and utilitarian

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in comparison. Vivo has slowly moved away from flashy gradient finishes and this colour is a good example of that shift. It has a warm, matte elegance to it, almost like how a lightly brushed metal chassis feels, but without the cold, slippery feel of actual metal.

The back uses glass fibre instead of pure glass and that subtle texture helps the phone feel secure even without a case.

Compared with last year's X200 Pro, the design has matured. The older model already had a clean look, but the X300 Pro pushes it further with flatter geometry, tighter symmetry and bezels that almost disappear when the display is off. The camera module still dominates the rear, but it blends into the housing more naturally. The metal ring around the ZEISS optics is more polished this time and the whole module feels less like an attached component.

The front uses the proprietary Armor Glass, which is rated tougher than the X200 Pro's protective glass solution and the middle frame is solid aluminium alloy. It feels denser and the weight distribution is noticeably better. The phone is still 226 grams, so it's not light by any means, but it doesn't lean heavily towards the top despite the large telephoto assembly.

Yes, the camera bump is big, but it has to be, considering the 1/1.28-inch main sensor and 200-megapixel telephoto underneath. The bump rises smoothly from the backplate instead of jutting out sharply like a separate disc.

The X300 Pro feels like Vivo is finally settling into a design identity for the X-series, something that feels premium from the get-go..

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

The Vivo X300 Pro uses MediaTek's Dimensity 9500 chipset and the day-to-day experience is exactly what the numbers suggest. The interface feels quick, apps resume without delay and OriginOS 6 keeps animations steady even when several tasks run in the background.

In benchmarks, the X300 Pro scores 3,524,707 in AnTuTu, 3433 in Geekbench single-core and 10,410 in multi-core, which places it ahead of the Oppo Find X9 Pro running the same chipset (3.41M AnTuTu, 3216/9490 Geekbench). The improvement isn't massive, but it does indicate slightly better tuning on Vivo's side, especially when considering sustained multi-core loads. PCMark Work reconfirm the same, with the Vivo X300 Pro reaching 16,139 compared to the Oppo Find X9 Pro's 13,218.

Thermals, however, remain a key trait of this generation of chips. In the CPU throttling test, the X300 Pro dropped to 62% of peak performance, which aligns with what you feel during extended tasks like exporting multiple RAW images or running CPU-heavy games for more than 20–25 minutes.